

Mainmast
Mikasa's fore- and aft- masts were used primarily as a mounting point for signals, lookouts, and radio apparatus. Fortified "fighting tops" on the masts were armed with light guns for raking fire.

Broadside guns
Mikasa's armored sides bristle with two rows of 3-in and 6-in broadside guns for use against smaller ships or to target the lightly armored superstructure of larger warships.



Funnels and ventilators
The smoke produced by *Mikasa*'s 25 coal-fired Belleville boilers exited the ship through two large funnels in the center of the deck. Several smaller ventilation shafts brought fresh air below deck.

Stern walkway
The admiral's cabin enjoyed direct access onto a narrow walkway around the stern end of the ship. The Japanese characters on the metal plate spell out the name of the battleship *Mikasa*.





Rangefinder
A Barr & Stroud FA3 rangefinder is mounted on the deck of the topgallant forecastle, behind the compass. A number of Russian ships at Tsushima were fitted with similar models, but better training meant the Japanese rangefinding proved far superior during battle.





Electric searchlight
A pair of long "wings" of decking extend on either side of the forecastle, down which the two large 35 in (90 cm) searchlights can be rolled. Powerful searchlights were essential at night and in fog to locate and target enemy ships and to prevent collisions.



Togo's command post
Admiral Togo commanded the fleet at Tsushima standing on the deck of the topgallant forecastle in front of this compass. Speaking tubes allowed him to send orders to the bridge below.



Forecastle
Underneath the foremast, looking toward the prow of the ship, are the main navigation and command areas: the pilothouse and bridge, the topgallant forecastle on the deck above, and two long "wings" on either side.



Bridge and chart room
This portside view of the forecastle shows the door to the pilothouse on the left and the chart room on the right. Steps lead up the topgallant forecastle with the compass and rangefinder. On the deck in front of the steps, the rails allowing the searchlights to be moved up and down the "wings" are just visible.